# Unit 1 — First Day Back

Track E · Klasse 7 · Niveau E

**Niveau E**

## 1. Reading

Read the text and use it for the activities below.

**A short classroom dialogue**

Read the dialogue silently first, then listen to the teacher read it aloud. Pay attention to the questions Ms. Reyes asks.

**Ms. Reyes.** Welcome back, Year 7. Aisha, you go first. One good thing about your summer — go.
**Aisha.** I went to my grandmother's village for two weeks. We made bread every morning.
**Ms. Reyes.** Bread every morning? That sounds like work. Did you enjoy it?
**Aisha.** Yes, but my arms got tired.
**Ms. Reyes.** Ben?
**Ben.** I, um — I built a bike ramp in the garden. With my cousin.
**Ms. Reyes.** And did it work?
**Ben.** It worked twice. Then it broke.
**Ms. Reyes.** Twice is enough for a story.

**Language focus — past simple**

Past simple in English uses two patterns.

- **Regular verbs** add `-ed`: *work → worked*, *enjoy → enjoyed*, *play → played*. Spelling: drop final *e* (*bake → baked*), double a final consonant after a short vowel (*stop → stopped*).
- **Irregular verbs** change form: *go → went*, *see → saw*, *make → made*, *have → had*, *get → got*, *build → built*, *break → broke*.

For questions and negatives, use *did / didn't* and the base form:

- *I went → Did you go? / I didn't go.*
- *She built → Did she build it? / She didn't build it.*

Common transfer error from German: *"I have made bread every morning"* sounds odd in English when there is a clear past time marker. English prefers simple past with a finished time ("*yesterday*", "*last week*", "*every morning that summer*"). Use present perfect only when "now" is part of the meaning.

## 2. Practise

**Niveau G — gap-fill**

Fill in the past simple form of the verb in brackets.

1. Last summer Aisha _____ (go) to her grandmother's village.
2. She and her grandmother _____ (make) bread every morning.

3. Ben _____ (build) a bike ramp with his cousin.
4. The ramp _____ (work) only twice.
5. After that, it _____ (break).
6. Ms. Reyes _____ (smile) and _____ (say), ”Welcome back.”

**Niveau M — transformation**
Rewrite each sentence in the past simple. Keep the meaning.

1. Aisha **goes** to her grandmother’s village every summer. → ___
2. They **bake** bread together. → ___
3. Ben **builds** a bike ramp. → ___
4. The ramp **breaks** after two jumps. → ___
5. He **does not give up**, though. → ___
6. Ms. Reyes **asks** the class one simple question. → ___

## 3. Your turn

**Writing task.** Write a short text titled ”One Day in My Summer”. Tell the reader **one** day, not the whole summer. Use past simple. Include at least:

- *one place* you went,
- *one person* you were with,
- *one thing* you ate, made, saw, or played,
- *one feeling* you had.

**Niveau G** — 60–80 words. **Niveau M** — 100–120 words.

**Sample student response (Niveau M, 112 words)**

One day in August, my cousin and I went to the lake near our grandmother’s village. The sun was hot and the water was cold, which was a good problem to have. We took bread and cheese in a small bag. My cousin can swim better than me, so I followed her across to the small island in the middle. We sat on a flat stone and ate everything in five minutes. On the way back, I lost one of my flip-flops. We laughed for a long time, and then we searched for it under the water until we found it.

Strong moves: one clear day, simple past throughout, named place and person, a small problem (”I lost a flip-flop”) that creates shape. Improve by varying connectives (”then”, ”after that”, ”while we were eating”) rather than only ”and”.

## 4. Further reading / listening

- BBC Learning English — *6 Minute English: Talking about your weekend.* https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/english/features/6-minute-english
- The Guardian Education — short *first-day-back* opinion pieces by teachers, e.g. https://www.theguardian.com/education (search "first day back").
- A simple read-aloud version of *Welcome back, Year 7* is in the shared `_classroom/` folder for absent students.